

November 28, 1972

accepted J.R. Gentry

Dear Jack,

Unfortunately, all I can find on the Anna's Hummingbird are the enclosed two letters written by Oppie. One to Dr. Scott, the used to be, regional editor of American Birds. The other is to Dave Pugh. I feel somewhere in Oppie's bird notes are the field notes on this hummingbird. But to date I haven't been able to find them.

You are right in presuming that the sighting was made by one observer. I did not see the bird, nor did Elva Fox, a finder Oppie most often banded with. Until I can find the notes or by chance a person, unknown to me, who saw the bird we should put the sighting on the Hypothetical List. I would like to have the sighting reviewed and voted on by the Committee, but really this would be unfair to other one person sightings of equal importance.

If you feel we can run the reports through the Committee, please don't have me judge Oppie. I couldn't give it a fair judgement.

Oppie started me banding sometime in 1966 and taught me to be careful and sure on an identification. If I wasn't doubt it. If she listed a bird, it was there. But this isn't proof, and it isn't what we are after here. Use your judgement.

Whatever the case, please let me know your decision.

Yours truly,
Kip

Accepted JF 6/30/74

August 19, 1970

Dear Dr. Scott,

This period was not so dry as the spring and winter. There was less precipitation than last year, but more a normal period. After the cold spring temperatures have been about normal.

Birding has been very good. I call this "the Hummingbird year". Judging by the great numbers of young there were good hatches everywhere. They have been present at feeders and yard in swarms, not only in Durango but west to Hesperus and east to Vallecito and down the Pine River, also up the Animas River valley and mountain meadows. Black-chinned and Rufous are especially good. The Broad-tailed, Black-chinned, Rufous, and Calliope have all been in my yard. Also, I had the unbelievable good fortune to be in the right place at the right time and get my first Anna's here June 21. I was adjusting a new feeder when I heard the distinctive note and wing noise at the feeder on my right. The feeder was almost 2½ ft. to my right. Here are my notes "Turned head slowly and bird was poised just above feeder on right. the throat and chin area looked black but the forehead was a rich rose-red as the bird moved his head. He fed from feeder finally stopping between sips. Anna's, though the color on the throat was not reflected, the sun was partially obscured by clouds and the light came from the bird's back. Other field marks quite evident. Voice, a hissing (very fast) or rattling with a cluck or click interspersed."

Pough's Audubon Western Bird Guide says "also a rapid, machine-gun-like series of rattled notes", which I felt was a good description. June 25 at 7:05 p.m. bird was seen at feeder again.

Elva Fox saw a Mockingbird along the Animas River on June 8 and again June 27. She and I looked for the bird several times above the river and along the river without any luck. On August 12 she saw one less than a mile from the river near a new development. She and I went to check this out and found the bird. Also the nest and at least 2 or 3 young being fed (grasshoppers). These young were out of the nest, one on lower limbs of the tree under the nest. On August 13 I found adult feeding a young bird in the nest. I could see only the bird's mouth taking the food from the adult and could not be sure it was a mockingbird. Nest too high for me and this bird could have been a cowbird. This is my first record of mockingbirds nesting here.

Accepted JR 6/30/74

101 West 31 Street
Durango, Colo. 81301
August 23, 1970

Dear Mr. Lupton,

Undoubtly it is too late for the next CFO issue, but I had hoped to get some more information on the Anna's Hummingbird. Getting an identification on this hummingbird was the unbelievable good luck of being at the right place at the right time. This is the "Year of the Hummingbirds" here. Never Have I seen so many Black-chinneds. Since June 10 they have been everywhere. One nest observed had young as early as June 18. I consider this species common here but usually do not see it so early in the season as the Broad-tailed. Every place I have visited has had swarms of Rufous, Broad-taileds, Black-chinneds with a sprinkling of Calliopes.

I find I have no copy of my note to you mentioning the Anna's. However, I find two dates noted. The correct date was June 21. 25 1970. This is a first record for an Anna's Hummingbird here for me. On these dates June 14, June 15, June 18 and June 20 I have noted an unidentified hummingbird at feeders. The Black-chinneds and Broad-taileds were feeding regularly at this time. From My note dated June 21---Finally saw color on the exasperating Hummingbird. Heard the distinctive note and wing noise when adjusting the new feeder, Turned head slowly and bird was poised just above feeder on right (less than 2 1/2 ft. away). The throat and chin area looked black but the forehead was a rich rose-red as the bird moved his head toward me when poised to side of feeder, and when stopping between sips while feeding. The color on the throat did not reflect, light came from the bird's back. All other field marks quite evident. Voice --a hissing, battling with a chick or chuck interspersed (very fast). June 25---Anna's Hummingbird at feeder at 7:05 P.M. (this was last date seen).

I did receive the No. 7 CFO issue, thank you. Very good birding here all season.

Yours truly,

Oppie Reames
Oppie Reames